

includes a screen-saver mode scanner that scans your PC in the background. Virus definitions can either be scheduled, or downloaded manually.

Notable alternatives

AVG 6 Free Edition

Vcatch Basic 5.0.20.2 [Bargain Buddy installed]

Firewalls

ZoneAlarm 4.5.594.000

ZoneAlarm is a good out-of-the-box firewall for people who

You can schedule ZoneAlarm to access the Internet (in a controlled manner) after office hours

malware was wrongly identified. You can configure the IE-resident utility to stop malware in its tracks automatically, to inform you before blocking it, or to ask permission to block it. It can also clean up the lists of last-visited Web sites, opened files, cookies, etc. SpyBot supports IE, Netscape Communicator and Opera.

Notable alternatives

Free Spyware Scanner

Bazooka Adware and Spyware Scanner 1.12

Compression

ZipGenius 5.5.1.400

ZipGenius supports scanner and digicam file formats as well—it imports pictures to compress from a scanner. It also supports local (proxy) networks as well as Star Office and Openoffice.org. A broad range of expression formats are supported. While it works, it does anti-virus checks, and does everything that most compression software do. But it also supports XX, UU and MIME/Base 64 encoding as a unique feature. It has a backup command that automatically creates a compressed archive of a selected folder. ZipGenius is good for administrators too, as it supports unattended setup.

Notable alternatives

UHA

7-Zip 3.1 pop

MULTIMEDIA Audio Players

Winamp 5.03

Winamp is one of the best and most capable audio players around, with a stable core and a very usable interface that can be changed using any of the hundreds of skins available.

Winamp supports a wide variety of plugins that help fill in any missing functionality easily. This includes things such

as new audio formats as well.

Winamp allows you to stream music over a network and set up an audio radio. The latest version comes with file management (Media Library), ID3 tag editing, AAC encoding, CD-burning and more. Winamp now supports skins of both version 2 and 3.

Notable alternatives

Quintessential Player 4.5

Musicmatch Jukebox Basic 8.2

Video Players

Fresh View 2.6

Fresh View is a multimedia file organiser. It can be used to create albums of image files, etc. Images can only be saved in the BMP, GIF and JPEG formats, but it supports more than 80 multimedia formats such as PNG, TIFF, MIDI, MP3, AVI, etc. It allows you to create HTML albums, to view pictures as slide shows. You can print images using toolbar buttons. Fresh View is easy to use, and pop-up tool tips are helpful. This file organiser does not have a batch-renaming facility, however you can rename files from the albums, which is not a difficult thing to do. Overall, Fresh View does justice to its job and can be termed as a good multimedia organiser.

Notable alternative

Fox Media Center 1.0

Music File Converter Easylame

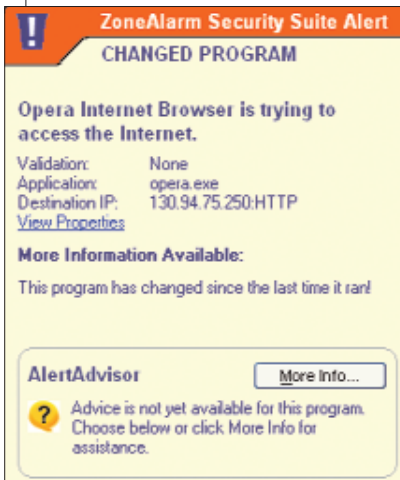
Easylame is considered as the best encoder to convert files from the .wav to the .mp3 format. This tool provides you with lots of options that can be customised. It comes with drag-and-drop functionality and has a friendly interface.

Notable alternative

MP3 Organizer

Media Cataloguing Whereisit

Whereisit is a media catalogue generator that keeps track of files and media on your disk. Managing media files using Whereisit is a happy experience—it works flawlessly. The best part is it does not bundle along any malware. ■



ZoneAlarm ensures that only known and wanted applications access the Internet services

understand the need for network security, yet are hesitant to configure a full-fledged firewall. ZoneAlarm is easy to deploy, and can be tweaked for better control. It offers an easy-to-use interface, a visual tutorial and good help features. It detects a new network connection automatically and assigns user-defined security levels.

Notable alternatives

Sygate Personal Firewall

AlertWall Personal Firewall

Anti Spyware SpyBot 1.3

This new version of SpyBot 1.3 is even more user-friendly and useful. Notable among its features is its huge comprehensive database of adware. SpyBot 1.3 displays spyware and adware search results in a tree format that can even be understood by a novice user. Before starting a search on your hard drive for malware, SpyBot performs a backup of the registry. A revert option lets you rollback if any



Winamp 5 supports both Winamp 3 and 5 skins, apart from other great features

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